

Incidents at Logan bring call for a closer look

Age, congestion could be safety factors, experts say

By Diti Kohli, Chris Serres, Scooty Nickerson, and Claire Thornton
GLOBE STAFF

Two aborted plane landings at Logan Airport last weekend raised red flags for travelers and drew alarm from the state's congressional delegation, with one member publicly pressing federal officials to expand their probe beyond a single Saturday incident.

An expert called a close call Saturday “pretty bad,” and three additional experts noted how Logan suffers from its age and design. The crisscrossing runways and taxiways of the 103-year-old facility — tucked between urban developments and the Boston Harbor — force congestion, which can raise the likelihood of collisions, near-misses, and incidents like those this past week.

But the events do not necessarily point to systemic safety issues at one of the nation's oldest airfields, experts said.

On Saturday, a Delta Airlines flight from Dallas reversed its descent into Logan around 11:30 a.m. to avoid an American Airlines plane readying for takeoff. The two aircrafts came within 900 feet of each other, in part because of misdirection from air traffic control, experts said.

“They cleared the [American] aircraft for takeoff and then completely forgot that they cleared the aircraft for takeoff,” said Michael McCormick, an assistant professor at Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University and a former

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From trenches of parenthood, a voice that said so much



Jill Smokler connected with her Scary Mommy blog, which she launched in 2008. **Obituary, C11.**

By Kara Baskin
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

When Scary Mommy founder Jill Smokler announced her glioblastoma diagnosis in 2024, I began to mourn her right away. A dear friend had recently died of the same disease, a form of brain cancer with a merciless prognosis. The median life expectancy is about 18 months. I knew what was in store. Selfishly, I hoped she would write about it, too, because she had guided me through so much already.

She died Monday at 48.

Smokler launched her Scary Mommy blog in 2008 with three little kids and no real game plan: “on a whim while the kids napped,” she told Time magazine in 2017. It was profoundly unfair — scary — that a woman who had become a defining voice in modern parenting would be cut down when her own kids were barely out of school.

Smokler, who grew up in Swampscott, was one of the first “mommy bloggers” at the dawn of the internet age. This common label undermines the complicated nature of her innovation, though.

Even though Smokler originally blogged as her kids napped — the dream of every aspiring mom-writer longing to make it big while stuck at a desk, I can assure you — she harnessed something essential: authenticity. Smokler was among the first mothers to embrace oversharing, vulnerability, and imperfection, just as the internet was taking off and exposing everyone's

MOM-BLOGGER, Page A7

‘I don’t see any hope’

Haitians in Mass. fear possible deportation after Supreme Court backs Trump



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

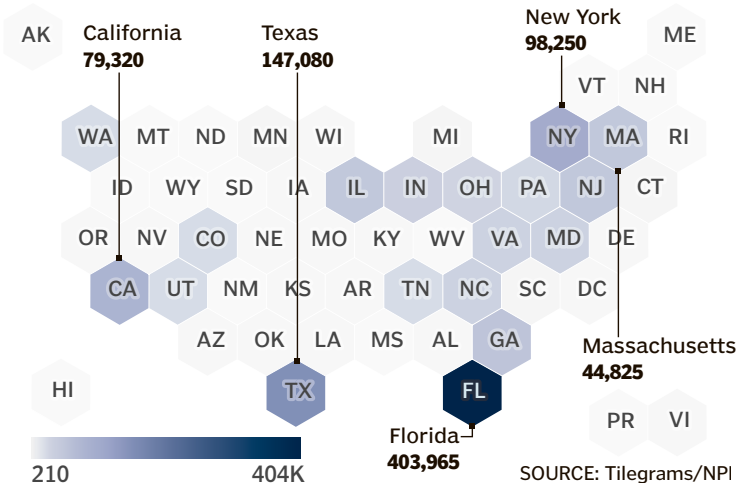
Dr. Gerald Gabeau, founder and CEO of IFSI-USA, embraced Governor Maura Healey after speaking at the State House.

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

The Supreme Court ruled Thursday that the Trump administration has the authority to revoke an immigration program that allows some 330,000 Haitians, including thousands in Massachusetts, to live and work legally in the United States on humanitarian grounds.

Temporary Protected Status, or TPS, shields immigrants from certain countries that are experiencing armed conflict, environmental disasters, or other extraordinary conditions from deportation. The program protected a total of 1.3 million people from 17 countries when

Temporary Protected Status holders by state and territory



President Trump took office.

The high court's 6-3 decision allows the Department of Homeland Security to move ahead with its plans to end the program for Haitians. Those who lose their TPS status will have to leave the country voluntarily or apply for other legal pathways to stay in the United States lawfully. Many could remain here without legal status, which could make them ineligible to work and leave them vulnerable to deportation.

Marckenson Gilles, a Haitian TPS holder who lives with his wife and three children in Boston, said he was in tears when he learned about the decision. He has two children who live here on

TPS, Page A6

Democrats want to know who got special drug access

White House denies obesity medication went to Trump

By Lizzy Lawrence
STAT

WASHINGTON — Democratic lawmakers have questions about the 79-year-old patient who received special access in April to retatrutide, Eli Lilly's experimental obesity drug, and are pressing the Trump administration on whether the person is the president or another prominent figure.

STAT reported on Tuesday that Eli Lilly and the Food and Drug Administration offered the drug to the patient, who has refractory obesity, obstructive sleep apnea, and pulmonary hypertension, via the FDA's “compassionate use” program. This pathway gives patients with serious and immediately life-threatening medical issues access to experimental treatments.

STAT also reported that the application, which was filed by a senior clinician at the National Institutes of Health, drew interest from top health officials, suggesting that the person receiving this drug was well connected. Outside ethical and clinical experts told STAT it was peculiar that Eli Lilly would open compassionate use for just a single patient when obesity is such a widespread condition.

STAT does not know who the patient is. But given the unusual nature

of the application and the patient's demographics, STAT asked the White House whether the patient was President Trump. Trump turned 80 this month, is overweight, and told The New York Times in January that he “probably should” take obesity drugs. He received an experimental treatment through the same pathway to treat his COVID-19 infection during his first administration.

After initially demurring when STAT first inquired, White House

DRUG, Page A7

Specter of alpha gal shakes up menus

Vineyard restaurants make changes for people who have tick syndrome

By Celina Colby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

OAK BLUFFS — Alex Wright misses eating burgers.

Since the Martha's Vineyard resident contracted alpha gal syndrome in July 2025, red meat has been off the table. Wright is a freelance photographer and works the counter at Mo's Lunch, a casual sandwich shop in the Portuguese American Club in Oak Bluffs. Sometimes the scent of patties sizzling in the kitchen drives him crazy.

“I didn't realize how emotionally attached to burgers I was until I couldn't have them,” Wright said.

Alpha gal syndrome is a serious, sometimes life-threatening illness transmitted through bites from the lone star tick that creates an allergy to red meat and dairy, as well as some medications. Relatively little is known about the as-yet-uncurable syndrome, but Martha's Vineyard Hospital says diagnoses have doubled since January 2025.



FINN GOMEZ FOR THE GLOBE

While island residents are accustomed to dealing with ticks, the arrival of the lone star — native to the South, likely carried here by migrating birds, and more aggressive than other species — has sounded a new kind of alarm. The syndrome floated around the news last summer, but this season it's escalated into a high-octane fear for Martha's Vineyard

ALPHA GAL, Page A5

Mocha Mott's in Oak Bluffs is one of the Martha's Vineyard restaurants that are finding ways around meat and dairy for alpha gal sufferers.

Venezuelans searched for survivors beneath collapsed buildings after a pair of powerful earthquakes. **A4.**

Taxi drivers in Boston now can accept trip requests through Uber and Lyft under a new one-year pilot program. **B5.**

The Supreme Court sided with the maker of the weedkiller Roundup, overturning a jury award for a Missouri man. **A2.**

Nice growing

Friday: A few showers. High 78-83. Low 65-70.

Saturday: Some sun, pleasant. High 72-77. Low 61-66.

Sunrise: 5:09 Sunset: 8:25

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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